

they're also converting their kids into fans. "There are 14- and 15-year-olds at our concerts singing 'Maaeri'," he says. "How do they know it? It's a 23-year-old song."

While Euphoria might be best remembered for their 1990s and early 2000s hits such as 'Maaeri', 'Dhoom Pichuk' and 'Aana Meri Gully', they've been regularly putting out music over the last two decades. They released their last album *Sale* as recently as 2021. As is common with long-running groups, the band has had its share of line-up changes, with Sen remaining constant as the main singer and songwriter, who pens the lyrics in collaboration with his sister Dahlia Sen Oberoi and friend Deekshant Sahrawat.

The composition of the instrumentalists has remained the same "for almost 12 years", featuring bassist DJ Bhaduri—who's been around as long as Sen—as well as tabla player Prashant Trivedi, percussionist Rakesh Bhardwaj, drummer Vishal Mehta, guitarist Aditya Shankar Benia, keyboardist Vishal Dixit, flautist Akshat Sharma, and backing vocalists Jayashree Basu, Debashree Basu and Sen's son Kinshuk, who is based abroad and joins in whenever he's in the country. Their process has also stayed consistent. "I come up with the idea of the song, the entire tune and some basic words as a guide," says Sen. "Then I present them to the band and they all come up with their parts. After the recording, I sit down as a producer to [decide] what we're going to retain."

Euphoria has been particularly busy both on the road and in the studio over the last couple of years. The ensemble, which plays an average of 80 to 100 concerts a year, including corporate shows and college gigs, has almost finished re-recording its first two albums, 1998's *Dhoom* and 2000's *Phir Dhoom*, both scheduled to be out at the end of January, and is ready with an all-new effort, slated to hit streaming services in April. Their reason for re-doing those initial LPs is the same as why Taylor Swift is doing the same for six of her full-length releases: to earn royalties from their own creations, which were signed away to labels years ago.

Sen, who says he's barely made any money from Euphoria's albums, admits he can't blame anybody, including himself, for those past decisions. "If I had been brave and said I'm not going to sign this, I would've been a great man but then my music would've never come out," he says. "Nobody would even know about it. I'm trying to correct that. I've not been with a label for 12 years. I've done everything independently. Whether people are watching or not, I'm going to do my stuff."

Doing his own thing extends to his belief in the power of elaborate music videos, a medium that proved particularly effective in popularising Euphoria. The band continues to release videos even in the age of Instagram reels and TikTok. "People who are serious about music, who want an experience, cannot be happy with 30 or 60 second [clips]," Sen says. "So I'm sticking to my original format."

The strategy seems to be working. Euphoria's Weekender set—which Sen promises will feature "some very interesting collaborations"—precedes a nationwide tour from December 9 to January 19 next year with stops in Indore, Jaipur, Bengaluru, Gurugram, Lucknow, Kolkata and Mumbai, making the trek their most extensive one yet. "This is one of my dreams that's coming true in our 25th year," says Sen. "It's like telling everybody, if we could do it, you can do it." ■

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The Bacardi NH7 Weekender festival will be staged from Dec 1-3. Tickets on Insider.in.







ELECTRIC MIX (clockwise from far left) Deep Purple, Parikrama, Parvaaz and Goo Goo Dolls

has] a very loyal, intelligent audience".

As for the city's status as "the rock capital", Roncon says that it used to be "at one point because there was a very strong promoter who loved the rock scene. [We're] trying to recreate what he started." He's referring to Venkat Vardhan, the founder of DNA Networks, which organised a number of concerts by international rock acts in the city from 2001 to 2012 before shifting focus to large-scale sporting events. These included gigs by Deep Purple, the Scorpions, Roger Waters, Aerosmith and Santana, to name a few.

While the listenership of rock on streaming services may be lower than that of hip-hop and pop today, the genre has remained popular on the live circuit, leading to the revival of the Independence Rock festival in Mumbai last year after a decade-long hiatus. Expectedly, the audience for rock skews older, and Bandland has been programmed accordingly. Deep Purple and Goo Goo Dolls will draw in the 1970s and '90s kids, and a group like The War on Drugs, whose music is reminiscent of Bruce Springsteen, forms a bridge between generations. "The thought was, how do I introduce a demographic like me, who listens to Deep Purple, to a new band? And how do I introduce a young audience to an older band?" says Roncon.

Though it might seem like Mumbai and Bengaluru is where most of the action's at, BookMyShow's long-term plan is to make Bandland a nationwide series comprising the main festival, single-day 'Arena' concerts—like the subsequently cancelled show with Deep Purple in Gurugram on December 15—as well as smaller gigs by local independent music bands, which will be held through the year. "While Bengaluru will be the hub, there will be spokes in other cities," says Roncon. ■

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Tickets on BookMyShow.com